

- ▶ **Device/Phone:** Before there was a Windows Phone, Microsoft created several generations of Zune portable media players, and you can manage those devices including which content is synced to them via the Device section. If you have a Windows Phone, this section will be named Phone while that device is plugged in, but it provides similar functionality.

Choose media to sync with the phone

Even if you have a tiny media library, or a phone with a large amount of storage this section can be very helpful. The number one way to segregate music content you'd like to sync to the device from the wider collection of music you don't want synced is to intelligently create and use playlists. Zune supports two types of playlists, "regular" playlists, and auto playlists. Both are created in **Collection > Music > Playlists**.

- ▶ **Regular playlists** are just dumb buckets. You can copy content into them, rearrange the order of the songs, and then sync them with your phone. You create a playlist by clicking New Playlist in the Playlist UI.
- ▶ **Autoplaylists**, called smart playlists elsewhere, are much more intelligent and much more interesting because they are dynamic. That is, the content of an autoplaylist can change over time depending on certain conditions. For example, maybe you want to just sync your favourite songs to the phone. Zune uses a three-tier song rating system that utilises cute little hearts to denote whether you like a song. The three possible choices are Like (a heart), Don't Like (a broken heart), and Not Rated (empty heart). To create an auto playlist of just those songs you like, click New Autoplaylist to display the Autoplaylist interface

Creating this autoplaylist is simple: Give it a name, change the Rating field to "Like," and optionally change the song limit from 100 to another number (or just clear the field to include all eligible songs). When you click OK, your new autoplaylist is created.

Subscribe to podcasts

Like many other modern media player solutions, the Zune platform supports subscribing to, managing, and playing podcasts, and this is an interesting option for those who like to listen to the radio but want content that is tailored specifically to their interests, and isn't location based. Podcasts are audio or video recordings, as you'd find on the radio. Some are spoken